nothing telling me I am tired, no other feeling than being where I am meant to be.

The figures read 16–3–35–7 as I eventually walk off. I would have bowled all day. They were the best figures anyone had returned in the Championship all season. I couldn't help but think as I turned around to the applause of rows of deckchairs, should I be going? Does this make sense to me that I should be finishing? Either way, the spell has helped me somehow. It's softened me, just to know I'm not delusional, I'm still as good as I've ever been. I'm all the bowlers I've ever been. There's a message on my phone when I get back to the dressing room. It's from Ben Stokes.

'Did you really have to do that?'

'Sorry, mate,' I said.